

Three Cool Compilers to Help You Program on Your Android Device

This article walks the reader through three programming compilers or IDEs, which can be used on Android devices—C4droid, Frink and JoyToy.



We all carry powerful programmable devices with us nowadays. Mobile phones are no longer just used to make calls. In our hands are mobile machines with good processing powers. Android devices can be used to write and execute programs just like a desktop but with certain limitations. Currently, developing apps for Android occupies a lot of the discussion space in the open source world.

C4droid

C4droid is a C/C++ IDE for Android with GNU Makefile, SDL and Qt support. C4droid supports devices with ARM processors only (not devices with Intel x86 or MIPS processors). You can create your own applications on Android devices and run them. C4droid uses an offline compiler. The result can be exported to an executable (for terminal apps) or APK (for apps with a GUI).

Installation

C4droid is available from Google Play. It is a paid app, but absolutely worth the price for people who cannot stay away from coding. I have only worked with the C capabilities of C4droid. To get the C++ support, the GCC plugin from the Android Market has to be installed.

Features

This app uses TCC and uClibc, which are designed for embedded systems (or GCC + Bionic with a plugin), so it has the full support of ANSI C and ISO C99 (and full C++ support with GCC). But you get access only to the standard C libraries with the uClibc. C4droid also provides some common features of every IDE like auto complete, source code formatting and source code highlighting.

A notable feature of C4droid is that it enables you to run